

A Code of Conduct for a football scout contract is designed to ensure integrity, professionalism, and the protection of young players. Scouts must act in accordance with governing body rules (such as FIFA, The FA, or regional associations) and club policies, with a primary focus on ethical practices.

Core Components of a Scout Code of Conduct

- **Integrity and Professionalism:** Scouts must operate with the highest standards of integrity and fair dealing, representing their club professionally. This includes avoiding conflicts of interest and disclosing any personal interest in a transaction.
- **Safeguarding and Protection:** Scouts must prioritize the safety of all children and young people, adhering strictly to safeguarding policies and undergoing necessary background checks (e.g., enhanced DBS/CRB).
- **Approach Protocols:**
 - Scouts must always introduce themselves to club officials and wear provided identification.
 - No direct or indirect approach should be made to a player contracted to another club without proper procedures.
 - Approaches to minors must follow strict age-related guidelines and require written consent from guardians.
- **Ethical Recruitment:**
 - Scouts must be honest and realistic with parents and players, never promising trials or contracts without authorization.
 - They should not abuse their position or pressure players/families.
 - They shall never ask parents money or any kind of benefits
- **Behavior and Conduct:**
 - Scouts must not interfere with the field of play or instruct players during games.
 - They should promote fair play and respect all officials, coaches, and players.
 - They must not use offensive language, harass, or discriminate against anyone.

- Compliance and Reporting: Scouts must comply with all laws of the country and relevant football regulations (e.g., The FA Agent Regulations). They must report any suspicious activity to the club's Welfare Officer.
- Data Protection and Loyalty: Scouts must maintain confidentiality regarding club information and demonstrate loyalty, not bringing the game into disrepute.

Consequences of Breach

Failure to adhere to the code can lead to disciplinary actions, including, but not limited to, a meeting with FA officials, suspension, or termination of their contract/membership.

Code of Conduct for Scouts

1. The function of a Scout is to identify to his Club players with whom his Club may wish to enter into negotiations with a view to securing their registration. Scouts are not themselves entitled to enter into any such negotiations nor are they able to make promises to or offer inducements to any players whom they approach.
2. Scouts are employed by and represent their Clubs and are Officials within the meaning of the Rules of the **F.A Premier League** ("the Rules") by which they are bound.
3. Scouts must therefore be familiar with the Rules and in particular Section N relating to Youth Development. They must maintain an awareness of and at all times comply with the Rules setting out the circumstances in which their Club may make an approach to a Player or Student (as defined in the Rules) whose registration is held by another Club.
4. When acting in the course of his duties a Scout shall at all times carry the formal means of identification issued to him by his Club and shall produce the same upon demand.

5. Scouts are responsible for the conduct of their contacts and shall be liable for any act or omission by a contact which constitutes a breach of the Rules.
6. Scouts shall conduct themselves in a manner befitting their role as Officials of their Clubs and shall take all possible steps to promote the reputation of the game of association football and to prevent it being brought into disrepute.
7. A Scout shall forthwith disclose to his Club the nature and extent of any direct or indirect interest he may have in any transaction or arrangement involving his Club and he shall account to his Club for any benefit which either directly or indirectly he derives therefrom.
8. A Scout shall conduct himself at all times in an ethical and professional manner and shall observe the highest standards of integrity and fair dealing.

Scouts should:

- Be employed / have volunteered through a rigorous recruitment process which would include an enhanced **CRB** & references.
- Have completed the FA 'Safeguarding Children and Young People in Football' workshop.
- Follow the football governing bodies' regulations, also know and understand the rules.
- Be registered with the Football League through the YD3 form.
- Promote and enhance the club image and demonstrate club loyalty.
- Have a job description / role specification dependent upon their employment status within the club.
- Understand and follow club recruitment induction protocols, and codes of conduct.
- Be issued with and wear Club ID badge, with a photograph, this should be renewed every season and state the current season. (ID badges

should be removed from any scout who is no longer involved with the club)

- Be empathetic to all aspects of grass-roots football – approach managers / officials at matches explain that they are observing and introduce themselves, identifying who they are and which club they represent.
- Understand the talent requirements of the club they represent and have knowledge of children's technical and physical development.
- Always be honest and realistic with parents and players.
- Receive some supervision by the club appropriate to the role and time employed / volunteering with the club. Stay in contact with the club, and deal with required paperwork.
- Attend club meetings and training when required by club.

Scouts should not:

- Abuse their position
- Make unrealistic promises to children, parents, or club managers.
- Observe games without introducing themselves to the officials at the match.
- Promise trials at clubs without the permission / agreement of the club.